

IMITAR CHAKAROV

Staff iOS Engineer

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Staff iOS Engineer with 16+ years in software and 7+ years scaling Just Eat Takeaway's consumer app to **13M monthly active iOS users across 14 countries**. I work at the platform layer — app architecture, modularisation, CI/CD, and the shared foundations a 60-engineer iOS organisation builds on. My impact comes from raising the technical bar across teams rather than within one: re-architecting core systems, driving company-wide adoption of modern Swift, owning the technical hiring bar, and establishing the forums and standards that keep a large chapter aligned. Promoted twice in four years, from mid-level to Staff.

EXPERIENCE

Staff iOS Engineer — Just Eat Takeaway.com Sep 2018 – Present · London

iOS Core / Platform & Experience team — owners of release, CI, app infrastructure, shared libraries and modularisation for the consumer app (13M iOS MAU, 14 markets, ~60 iOS engineers, 47 modules, 100% Swift).

- **Re-architected the app's core foundations (Project Backbone):** led the design of a new dependency-injection framework and app-lifecycle manager, solving a long-standing circular-dependency problem and delivered as a zero-regression "big bang" switchover. Created the testable, scalable base that made the OneApp consolidation possible as the team doubled in size.
- **Modernised the network layer (APIClient / Project Token):** replaced legacy concurrency with structured async/await and actors to eliminate data races in token refresh — a 26-PR effort that cut spurious user logouts, improved stability, and simplified development for every feature team. Network layer is the backbone of the whole app.
- **Drove company-wide adoption of modern Swift:** introduced SwiftUI, Combine and async/await into the codebase, then led the Swift 6 / strict-concurrency migration across 47 modules — building the tracker, adoption plan and documentation other teams worked from.
- **Built a strategic engineering partnership with Apple from scratch:** became the company's primary contact with Apple's Worldwide Developer Relations, securing recurring workshops and 1:1s. This made the app one of the first in its category to ship Liquid Glass on day one of iOS 26, earning an App Store feature and an invitation for the team to present the implementation at Apple HQ.
- **Owns the iOS technical hiring bar across ~20 teams:** redesigned the interview around a live pairing session, cutting time-to-hire from weeks to days and improving signal and candidate diversity; built the interviewer-training programme that has onboarded ~10 interviewers. Every candidate recommended for hire has succeeded and progressed.
- **Established the chapter's technical-governance forums:** created the design-document review process (50+ proposals scrutinised) and the iOS Discussion Forum — described by the Principal Engineer as "the best example of your leadership skills across the iOS group" — as the venues where a 60-engineer chapter aligns on architecture, dependencies and standards.
- **Scaled the app to new markets:** key contributor to OneApp consolidation, redesigning country-switching and leading the NZ→Menulog and Ireland→Just Eat app migrations that became the blueprint for subsequent market merges.
- **Shipped measurable product wins:** led Guest Checkout (est. +2M orders/year by reducing checkout friction); delivered observability via Metrickit + Datadog, a two-tier alerting system on PagerDuty that cut alert fatigue, and a rating-email fix that lifted review rates ~6%. Regularly deputises for the team's manager — running chapter meetings, standups and releases.

Promoted Mid-level → Senior (Apr 2021) → Staff (Nov 2022). Consistently rated "Successful"/"Impressive" on values & impact.

EARLIER CAREER

Senior iOS Developer, What Now Travel — rebuilt a legacy iOS app to a modern Core Data / Storyboards architecture with CI and unit testing.	2016–2017
Mobile Team Lead & Senior iOS Engineer, InnoSys — led a 5-person cross-platform team; built & shipped the Swift Broker Assessment app for Hollard Insurance (Touch ID, secure data, adaptive UI).	2013–2016
Co-founder & Lead iOS Developer, JI Apps — shipped 10+ App Store apps incl. streaming apps for major Bulgarian TV networks and several #1-ranked titles.	2011–2016

CTO, On-Ed — built an online-education platform from idea to product; managed a team of 7; introduced Git workflow and payment/webinar integrations. **2012–2015**

Web & Backend Developer, All Data Processing, Spirali, Stiva Soft, Orbitel — PHP/Yii web apps, Elasticsearch dashboards; foundations as a full-stack engineer. **2005–2013**

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Swift (expert), Objective-C, Swift Concurrency & Swift 6 strict concurrency; some PHP/JS background
iOS & UI	SwiftUI, UIKit, Combine, App Intents, Live Activities, CarPlay, Core Data, Auto Layout
Architecture	Modularisation (47 modules), dependency injection, MVVM-C, app lifecycle & networking layers, API design
Platform / CI	Fastlane, Jenkins, Git/GitFlow, release management, MetricKit, Datadog, PagerDuty, code-owners tooling
Leadership	Technical hiring & interviewer training, mentoring, design-doc & governance processes, cross-team & Apple-partner stakeholder management

EDUCATION & BEYOND

BEng, Electronics — Technical University of Sofia (2006).	Outside core engineering: Education Outreach Lead and Neurodiversity Community SteerCo member; certified Mental Health First Aider; STEM mentor. Languages: Bulgarian (native), English (fluent).
CS188.1x Artificial Intelligence — BerkeleyX / edX (2012).	